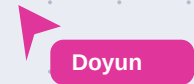


Doyun Kim



UX/UI designer and web developer

I design interfaces that help people feel included online. I graduated from UC Irvine in Informatics with a Human-Computer Interaction specialization and now study Integrated Design, Business and Technology at USC.

Research first

Then prototype

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About

Designer and researcher. My work explores how technology can nurture empathy, belonging, and healthier social interaction in digital spaces.

Education

- **University of Southern California**, M.S. in Integrated Design, Business and Technology. August 2026 to present.
- **University of California, Irvine**, B.S. in Informatics, Human-Computer Interaction specialization. September 2021 to March 2026. GPA 3.64, Dean's Honor List (4 quarters).
- **Irvine Valley College**, A.A. in Computer Science, magna cum laude.

Experience

- **Independent property manager and owner**, Haeundae, South Korea. January 2025 to present. Manage a commercial property and hold tenant meetings to learn how the space and the business can work better, which taught me about tenant experience and service design.
- **Chaplain assistant and rifleman**, 11th Maneuver Division, South Korea. August 2023 to January 2025. Completed mandatory military service. Supported religious services and unit morale while meeting combat readiness duties. Built teamwork, leadership, and quick decision-making under pressure.
- **Remote teacher assistant**, Veritas Academy. August 2020 to May 2021. Redesigned subject syllabi with a user-centered approach and built an interactive scheduling calendar for each classroom in C++ and Python.

Recognition

- 2nd place, inclusive design showcase sponsored by Riot Games, IDEO, and Fair Play Alliance (2023).

Skills

- **Design:** Figma, Sketch, Adobe Illustrator, wireframing and prototyping, user research, design thinking.
- **Build:** JavaScript, Python, Java, C++.
- **Collaborate:** Miro, Slack, project management.

Shoppyst

Browser extension for the startup Shoppyst. Team MatchaCart, five students. My role: UI/UX designer, September 2025 to March 2026.

Companies spend on politics through donations, lobbying, and advocacy, but shoppers rarely see it. Shoppyst shows a brand's score on an issue you care about, right on the shopping page. You can **stay** on the site or **go** to a higher-scoring alternative.

95.2% of 20+ surveyed shoppers said they would use it while shopping.

Figma, Vue.js, MongoDB, Firebase, Cloudflare Workers (team stack)

[View the Figma prototype](#)

Design

- Merged the score and the alternatives into one panel, so everything is on a single page.
- Built the Stay/Go idea into a floating badge and a slide-out Go-list.
- Kept one architecture with a color theme per issue, plus light and dark modes.
- Designed login, signup, onboarding, and a plain-language transparency note.

Accessibility and ethics

- Checked contrast with a11y tools and added clearer labels and shadows.
- Showed each score as a ring, a color, a word, and a number, so color is never the only signal.
- Tracked only data needed for the experience, anonymized it, and replaced generic disclosures with clear explanations.

Testing

The team tested across Amazon, Nike, and Adidas in repeated cycles, ran a survey with online shoppers, did a quick usability test with a colorblind user, and completed a heuristic evaluation. Feedback stressed transparency and readability.

Next steps

Google sign-in, a settings page, referral tracking, separate builds for each issue, and testing with a wider age group before launch.

Positivity Perks

Team project at UCI, January to March 2023. Six students. 2nd place at a showcase sponsored by Riot Games, IDEO, and Fair Play Alliance.

Our question: how might we design healthy, inclusive digital spaces where people thrive? We narrowed it to online ranked games, where toxic behavior is common, and designed Positivity Perks, a system that rewards positive communication and teamwork.

User research, Miro, prototyping, usability testing

[View the full project](#) | [View Positivity Perks](#)

Research

I ran a literature review on goal alignment, team structure, and matchmaking, and turned it into design principles for our concepts. The team also observed ranked play and ran six semi-structured interviews with game developers, beginning gamers, and players who play as part of their personal identity. We grouped everything into codes and themes with thematic analysis in Miro.

Concepts

We tested four ideas: ranking penalties for poor communication, in-match rewards for helpful communication, filtering hostile language, and design standards for developers. Players preferred concepts that punished poor communication, while developers preferred rewarding good communication. Both groups wanted immediate feedback and a multi-part solution.

Prototype

Positivity Perks grew from storyboards and task flows into paper and low-fidelity prototypes for login, home, rewards, community, and match history pages. We tested it with a think-aloud protocol, then iterated on the themes we found.

Distraction News redesign

Group project at UCI. Team of four.

The children's show Distraction News moves fast, with flashing images and quick cuts. That overwhelms many neurodiverse learners, especially those with ADHD or autism. We redesigned it so viewers control how stimulating it is.

Why it needed to change

The tempo was too fast to follow, sound and visuals came at once, and nothing supported memory or focus. We grounded the critique in Cognitive Load Theory, Mayer's multimedia principles, and Universal Design for Learning, and compared it with BrainPOP and GoNoodle.

What we designed

- A "Calm Mode" that removes flashing lights and background noise.
- A "Distraction Level" slider, plus pause, repeat, and playback speed controls.
- Subtitles in multiple languages, adjustable difficulty, and a digital note-taking area.
- Before and after wireframes, and a four-panel storyboard of a child using the new version.

Ethics and next steps

We planned A/B testing with neurodiverse learners, with consent, data privacy, and student dignity as priorities. Screen reader support and calm comprehension checks came next.

UCI League GOATS

Project management class at UCI. Team EASYMONEY, five students.

We planned a League of Legends tournament for UCI students and staff to reconnect people with campus through gaming. We chose the game by team vote, scouted the UCI Esports venue, built the budget and rank-based brackets, and made the poster and registration form. The event was not held because we could not secure funding.

What we learned

Sponsors were hard to find, and costs ran higher than our first estimate. Next time I would contact sponsors at the start of the project instead of the middle. We also learned to weigh every teammate's opinion and that a problem usually has more than one good answer.

In progress

Two USC projects, fall 2026.

Sleep on the road, with Belkin

USC studio project. Team of four, in collaboration with Belkin. My role: UX researcher.

Working adults who travel often lose the wind-down routine that helps them sleep at home. We are designing a travel-friendly product that recreates a restful sleep environment anywhere, using affordable, widely available technology and without disturbing the people or space around the user.

Who we design for. Working adults aged 25 to 40 who travel for work and leisure, spend a lot of time on screens, and feel unrested even after sleeping enough hours.

Where we focused. We mapped the evening from setting up the room to falling asleep, and chose the wind-down stage. Our solution space is physical and mental relaxation plus natural light exposure, using sight, sound, touch, and scent.

Four concept directions. A glasses and eye mask convertible; Moon (E)scape, a collapsible charging dock that doubles as a night light; a nightstand dock and portable puck; and my concept, the Scent Speaker, a compact bedside speaker with a built-in scent diffuser and swappable scent cartridges.

Compassionate AI across cultures

USC project. Group of five, in collaboration with Compassion AI.

Generative AI can favor dominant Western perspectives and flatten cultural nuance, so people from diverse cultures often get responses that miss the mark. We are studying what compassionate AI needs to look like for them.

What we found and heard. Compassion is shifting from sounding kind to understanding context and producing meaningful outcomes. People told us that compassion goes beyond empathy, that AI should ask questions before validating or answering, and that it should strengthen human compassion rather than replace it.

Three trends. Cultural context is becoming essential. Personalization, including memory, enables cultural relevance. Human judgment stays critical in sensitive areas like healthcare and emotional support.

Three directions we are exploring. AI for people from other cultures living in the US, how major AI companies support users from different cultures, and AI in other countries, including for travelers.

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